

Huanjia Ma

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SUMMARY

My research focuses on regional economics, innovation, firm behaviour and policy evaluation. I have a growing publication pipeline, experience in leading funded projects, and a track record of producing research that informs both academic scholarship and policy.

EDUCATION

University of Birmingham

PhD Economics

September 2017 - January 2022

University of Manchester

Msc Economics

September 2014 – November 2015

School of Oriental and African Studies

Bsc Development Economics

September 2009 – July 2012

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCES

City REDI, University of Birmingham

Research Fellow

February 2022 – Present

Birmingham, United Kingdom

RESEARCH

Regional R&D spending, absorptive capacity and the regional innovation paradox

with Kurt Kratena & Matthew Lyons & Raquel Ortega-Argiles - Forthcoming *Spatial Economic Analysis*

New Player or New Game

with Alessandra Guariglia & Dongqiang Liang - Revise and Resubmit - *Journal of Comparative Economics*

UK Levelling up R&D mission effects: A multi-region input-output approach

with Matthew Lyons & Raquel Ortega-Argiles

Working in Progress

Regional Wage Returns to Advanced Digital Skills and Job Digitalisation: Evidence from UK Job Vacancy Data

with Konstantinos Kollydas1 & Anne Green

Green procurement, supply chain and innovation

with Xin Deng

Fighting pollution through connection: Patron-client network and environmental protection in China

with Kai Cheng & Bowen Liu & Robert Elliot

University ownership, and fundraising in university spinouts

with Fumi Kitagawa & Nuo Jin

NON-ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

Ma, H., Collinson, S., Lyons, M. (2022) **Poorer Communities Bear the Burden of Economic Shocks: The Wider Socio-Economic Impacts of Firm Insolvencies** in *Birmingham Economic Review 2023* Great Birmingham Chamber of Commerce

Todd, J.D., Carr, P.L., Davies, R., Ji, Y., Lyons, M., & Ma, H. (2024). **The BBC in the West Midlands**. BBC.

Ma, H., Green, A., Kollydas, K., & Lyons, M. (2024). **Digital Skills Demand and Shortages and Their Impact on UK Regional Economies**. City-REDI - University of Birmingham

Mulla, I., Dwight, D., Gasienica-Fronek, L., Forde, E., Kitagawa, F., Bramley, G., Ma, H., Jin, D., Blake-Carr, R., Lyons, M. & Arriaga Garcia, G. J. (2025). **Exploring Emerging and Future Opportunities in the West Midlands Combined Authority Region**. West Midlands Combined Authority, 12 June, 52 pp.

GRANTS AND PROJECTS

Awarded

Evaluating the impact of digital skills shortages in the UK

January 2023 to July 2024

Research England QR funding, Principal Investigator

Grant Amount: £50,000

Abstract: This project looks at the impact of the digital skills shortage on UK firm productivity and innovation as well as the impact on the wider economy, building up on big data of UK job postings combined with firm-level analysis.

Selected Funded Research Projects (as Co-I or Researcher)

Innovation Procurment Empowerment Centre Partnership

On-going

Funder: Connected Place Catapult

Evaluation of Preventitative spending

On-going

Funder: Research England QR

FDI into Midlands's University Spinouts

On-going

Funder: AHRC

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant

2018 PG Econometrics, University of Birmingham

2019 UG China and World Economy, University of Birmingham

2020 UG Corporate Finance, University of Birmingham

Marking

2019 - 2020 UG Principle of Economics, University of Birmingham

2021 PG Macroeconomics, University of Birmingham

Supervision

2025 Msc in International Business dissertation, University of Birmingham

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2019 Midlands Regional Doctoral Colloquium

2021 7th International Young Finance Scholar's Conference

2022 2022 Royal Economic Society Annual Conference

Regional Science Association Winter Conference

9th Hispanic-American Conference on Input-Output Analysis

2023 2023 Royal Economic Society Annual Conference

14th Geoffrey J.D. Hewing's Regional Economics Workshop

Regional Science Association Winter Conference

The 23rd China Economic Annual Conference

2024 7th Geography of Innovation Conference (GeoInno 2024)

China Economic Association (UK/Europe) Annual Conference

2025 Regional Science Association International - British and Irish Chapter Conference

RESEARCH SKILLS

Languages: Native Chinese, Fluent English

Statistical Software and programming languages: Stata, Eviews, R, Python

REFERENCES

Alessandra Guariglia

Professor of Economics

Department of Economics

University of Birmingham

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Raquel Ortega-Argilés

Professor of Regional Economic Development

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